

How Americans View AI and Its Impact on People and Society

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Americans see a role for AI in some areas of society but want more control over its use. About half say it'll erode creative thinking



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Link to source

- https://www.pewresearch.org/science/2025/09/17/how-americans-view-ai-and-its-impact-on-people-and-society/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

Main Findings

- The Pew Research Center survey finds that **Americans are generally cautious and skeptical about the growing role of artificial intelligence in daily life**. While nearly all U.S. adults are aware of AI, **more people feel concerned than excited** about its increased use. A majority believe AI is more likely to **erode human abilities**, particularly **creative thinking** and the ability to **form meaningful relationships**, rather than improve them.
- At the same time, Americans show a **pragmatic openness** to AI when it serves as a *support tool*. Most respondents are willing to let AI assist with **routine or data-heavy tasks**, such as weather forecasting, fraud detection, and developing new medicines. However, there is strong resistance to AI being involved in **personal or deeply human domains**, such as religion, matchmaking, or faith-based guidance.
- Another key finding is the public's strong desire for **transparency and control**. Most Americans want to know whether content is created by AI or humans, yet many lack confidence in their ability to tell the difference. This underscores widespread concerns about trust, authenticity, and accountability in an AI-driven society.

Broader Implications for Society

- The article highlights a central tension shaping AI's future in society: **people accept AI as a tool, but not as a replacement for human judgment, creativity, or relationships.** Public opinion suggests that AI adoption will be most successful when it is **clearly limited, transparent, and purpose-driven**, especially in areas that improve efficiency without undermining human agency.
- The findings also imply that **governance, labeling, and ethical standards** will become increasingly important as AI systems produce more content and influence decision-making. Without safeguards that preserve human oversight, public trust in AI could weaken, slowing adoption and increasing social resistance. Overall, the study suggests that society favors a **human-centered AI model**, where technology augments rather than replaces human capabilities.

Relevance and Potential Influence on the Construction Industry

- These findings are highly relevant to the **construction industry**, where AI is increasingly used for **planning, scheduling, cost estimating, risk analysis, safety monitoring, and predictive maintenance**. The survey suggests that AI is most likely to be accepted in construction when it supports **data-intensive and analytical tasks**, such as clash detection, schedule optimization, and material forecasting—areas aligned with public comfort around AI handling complex data.
- However, the skepticism around AI replacing creativity and human judgment indicates that **design decisions, leadership, and trade coordination will still need strong human involvement**. Construction professionals may resist AI systems that appear to override experience-based decision-making or ethical responsibility.
- The emphasis on transparency also points to the need for **clear documentation and explainable AI tools** in construction workflows. Stakeholders—owners, contractors, and regulators—will likely demand visibility into how AI-driven recommendations are generated, particularly when they affect safety, cost, or compliance. Ultimately, the article suggests that AI's success in construction will depend on its role as a **decision-support tool**, not a decision-maker, reinforcing trust while improving efficiency.
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